

Promises and Pressure: A Missing Voice

承诺与压力：缺席的声音

Theme: 友谊、家庭与人际关系 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

A **neighbor** in the dormitory, a **careful** woman who had never once complained, asked to speak to the group. She was a **delegate** from the night shift, and her story had no **art** in it: an **alcoholic father**, a **mother** who worked **six** days a week, and a brother who had left **school** at fifteen. “I do not **hate** them,” she said. “I just **remember** everything.” **Six** months **ago** the **project** had one voice; **see** how a single **person** can change the **parent** document.

Her **expression** did not change when she described the **accident**, but her hands did. “**There** was no **violence** in our house,” she said, “only a **fright** every evening.” The group had expected a story about money; **what** emerged was a story about a **clock**, a **lap**, and a chair by the window. “**So** the **survey** missed the **substance**,” Maya said. **However**, the **information** was still thin, and not one **word** of it had been checked.

The dominant voice in the room had always belonged to people with qualifications. “A **qualification** is a permission, not a **person**,” the woman said. “Do not be a **coward** about the **scope**.” A **thoughtful word**, a **homely** detail, a **neat** list of small comforts: the group wrote them down with the **devotion** of students who had learned to listen.

The **palace** of theory was **immune** to such evidence, and that was the **sting**. “An **intellectual project** that cannot **communicate grief** is a **bore**,” Professor Zhao said. “Not a failure — a **bore**.” The **sting** of the **word** angered Maya, and she was **careless** about her own tone in reply; the **black** coat made her look older than she was. “**Any** of you would have done the same,” she said, and regretted it at once.

They invited the woman to sit on the panel and allowed her to set the agenda. She stimulated one change immediately: the **survey** would ask **what** people **tend** in their own homes, not **what** they **wear** to the interview. “**There** is a **probable** reason nobody asked before,” Lin wrote. “The people who write surveys are the people who answer them.” His **mother** telephoned that evening, and he told her about the woman; she said only, “Good,” which was, from her, a long speech. A **conscientious** student would have apologized at once; the **shame** of the moment was that she had not. A **charitable** reading was possible, but it did not make the room **any** warmer, and the **dominance** of the loudest voice in it was itself a kind of **violence** that no **contemporary** account would ever record. She had seen enough suffering to know the difference.

中文翻译

宿舍里的一位邻居，一位从不抱怨的细心女人，请求和小组谈一谈。她是夜班的代表，她的故事里没有艺术：一个酗酒的父亲、一个每周工作六天的母亲，以及一个十五岁就离开学校的哥哥。“我不恨他们，”她说，“我只是记得一切。”六个月前这个项目只有一个声音；看看一个人如何改变那份母文件。

她描述那场事故时表情没有变化，但她的手变了。“我们家没有暴力，”她说，“只有每天晚上的一场惊吓。”小组原本期待一个关于钱的故事；浮现出来的却是关于一只钟、一个膝头，以及窗边一把椅子的故事。“所以调查漏掉了实质，”曼雅说。然而，这些信息仍然很薄，而且其中没有一个字被核对过。

屋里占主导的声音一直属于那些有资格的人。“资格是一种许可，不是一个人，”那位女士说，“不要因为范围就做个懦夫。”一句体贴的话、一个朴实的细节、一份整洁的小小安慰清单：小组用学会了倾听的学生的虔诚把它们记下来。

理论的宫殿对这类证据免疫，而这正是刺痛之处。“一个无法传达悲痛的智识项目是令人厌烦的，”赵教授说，“不是失败——是令人厌烦。”这个词的刺痛让曼雅愤怒，而她回话时的语气也很粗心。“你们任何人都会这么做，”她说，随即就后悔了。

他们邀请这位女士进入评审小组，并允许她来设定议程。她立刻促成了一项改变：调查要问人们在自家照料什么，而不是问他们穿着什么来面试。“没有人早先问过，有一个很可能的理由，”林伟写道，“写调查的人，就是回答调查的人。”那天晚上他母亲打来电话，他跟她讲了这位女士；她只说了一句“好”——而对她来说，那就是一段很长的讲话。一个尽责的学生本会立刻道歉；此刻的耻辱正在于她没有。做一种善意的解读是可能的，但这并不会让屋里更暖一些；而屋里最响的那个声音所占的支配地位，本身就是一种暴力，任何当代的记述都不会把它记下来。她见过的苦难足够多，因此分得清其中的差别。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
see si: POS: vt	vt. 看见, 查看, 参观, 游览, 理解, 知道, 同意; vi. 看, 观看, 注意, 知道, 考虑; n. 主教的职位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the seat within a bishop's diocese where his cathedral is located; v. perceive by sight or have the power to...
allow ə'laʊ POS: vt	vt. 允许, 同意给予, 承认; vi. 容许, 猜想; [计] 允许命令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. let have; v. give or assign a resource to a particular person or cause; v. allow or plan for a certain possibility...
expect iks'pekt POS: vt	vt. 预期, 盼望, 期待 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. regard something as probable or likely; v. look forward to the probable occurrence of; v. consider reasonable...
project 'prɒdʒekt POS: n	n. 计划, 设计, 事业; vt. 计划, 设计, 投掷, 发射, 使凸出, 放映; vi. 凸出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a planned undertaking; v. communicate vividly; v. transfer (ideas or principles) from one domain into another...
wear weə POS: n	n. 穿着, 戴, 使用, 耗损, 服装, 耐久性; vt. 穿着, 戴, 留(须、发等), 呈现, 磨损, 磨成, 耗损, 使疲乏, 消磨... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. impairment resulting from long use; n. the act of having on your person as a covering or adornment; v. be dressed...
suffer 'sʌfə POS: vt	vt. 遭受, 经历, 忍受; vi. 受痛苦, 受损害 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. undergo or be subjected to; v. undergo (as of injuries and illnesses); v. experience (emotional) pain; v. get...
tend tend POS: vi	vi. 走向, 有某种的倾向, 易于, 照顾, 注意; vt. 照料, 护理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have a tendency or disposition to do or be something; be inclined; v. have care of or look after; v. manage...
survey sə'vei POS: n	n. 纵览, 视察, 测量, 俯瞰, 调查; vt. 审视, 视察, 俯瞰, 通盘考虑; vi. 测量土地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a detailed critical inspection; v. consider in a comprehensive way; v. look over carefully or inspect; v. make...
violence 'vaɪələns POS: n	n. 猛烈, 暴力, 暴虐, 暴行; [法] 暴行, 暴力, 暴乱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an act of aggression (as one against a person who resists); n. a turbulent state resulting in injuries and...
expression ik'spreʃən POS: n	n. 表达, 表现, 词语, 措辞; [计] 表达式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the feelings expressed on a person's face; n. expression without words; n. the communication (in speech or writing)...
accident 'æksɪdənt POS: n	n. 意外事件, 机遇, 事故, 次要方面; [化] 意外事故; 事故 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unfortunate mishap; especially one causing damage or injury; n. anything that happens suddenly or by chance...
emerge i'mɜ:dʒ POS: vi	vi. 浮现, 形成, 出现, (事实) 显露 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. come out into view, as from concealment; v. become known or apparent; v. come up to the surface of or rise...
neighbor 'neɪbə POS: n	n. 邻居; vt. 邻接; vi. 毗邻而居, 友好; a. 邻近的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who lives (or is located) near another; n. a nearby object of the same kind; v. live or be located...
hate heit POS: n	n. 憎恨, 恨, 厌恶; vt. 憎恨, 憎恶; vi. 仇恨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the emotion of intense dislike; a feeling of dislike so strong that it demands action; v. dislike intensely...
careful 'keəfʊl POS: a	a. 小心的, 谨慎的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. exercising caution or showing care or attention; s. cautiously attentive; s. unhurried and with care and diligence...
palace 'pælɪs POS: n	n. 宫, 宫殿, 华丽大厦 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large and stately mansion; n. the governing group of a kingdom; n. a large ornate exhibition hall; n. office...
contemporary kən'tempərəri POS: n	n. 同时代的人; a. 同时代的, 属于同一时期的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person of nearly the same age as another; s. characteristic of the present; s. belonging to the present time...
substance 'sʌbstəns POS: n	n. 物质, 实质, 主旨, 资产, 本质, 牢固; [化] 物质 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the real physical matter of which a person or thing consists; n. material of a particular kind or constituting...
anger 'æŋɡə POS: n	n. 忿怒; vt. 激怒, 使发怒; vi. 发怒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a strong emotion; a feeling that is oriented toward some real or supposed grievance; n. the state of being...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
qualification ˌkwɒlɪfɪˈkeɪʃən POS: n	n. 资格, 条件, 限制; [计] 限定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an attribute that must be met or complied with and that fits a person for something; n. the act of modifyin...
scope skeɪp POS: n	n. 范围, 机会, 广度, 眼界, 观察仪器, 导弹射程; [计] 作用域 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an area in which something acts or operates or has power or control: "the range of a supersonic jet"
clock klok POS: n	n. 时钟, 计时器, (袜子上的)绣花边花; vt. 绣花样, 计时, 记录; vi. 记录时间; [计] 时钟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a timepiece that shows the time of day; v. measure the time or duration of an event or action or the person...
communicate kə'mjuːnɪkeɪt POS: vt	vt. 显露, 传达, 感染; vi. 通讯 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. transmit information; v. transmit thoughts or feelings; v. join or connect; v. be in verbal contact; intercha...
comfort 'kʌmfət POS: n	n. 舒适, 安慰, 安慰者; vt. 安慰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of being relaxed and feeling no pain; n. a feeling of freedom from worry or disappointment; n. satis...
intellectual ˌɪntəˈlektʃʊəl POS: n	n. 有知识者, 知识分子, 凭理智做事者; a. 智力的, 用脑力的, 聪明的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who uses the mind creatively; s. of or associated with or requiring the use of the mind; a. appeali...
lap læp POS: n	n. 膝盖, 舔, 一圈, 下摆, 衣兜, 山坳; vi. 重叠, 围住, 轻拍, 舔; vt. 包围, 抱...在膝上, 使重叠, 舔, 拍... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the upper side of the thighs of a seated person; n. an area of control or responsibility; n. the part of a p...
stimulate 'stɪmjuleɪt POS: vt	vt. 刺激, 激励, 鼓舞; vi. 起刺激作用 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. act as a stimulant; v. stir the feelings, emotions, or peace of; v. cause to be alert and energetic; v. stir...
shame ʃeɪm POS: n	n. 羞耻, 羞愧, 耻辱; vt. 使羞愧, 侮辱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a painful emotion resulting from an awareness of inadequacy or guilt; n. a state of dishonor; v. compel thro...
delegate 'delɪgeɪt POS: n	n. 代表; vt. 委派...为代表 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person appointed or elected to represent others; v. transfer power to someone; v. give an assignment to (a...
neat ni:t POS: a	a. 整洁的, 巧妙的, 匀称的, 简洁的; n. 牛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. clean or organized; s. showing care in execution; s. free from what is tawdry or unbecoming; s. without water
grief gri:f POS: n	n. 伤心, 忧愁, 悲痛, 不幸, 灾难 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. intense sorrow caused by loss of a loved one (especially by death); n. something that causes great unhappin...
immune ɪ'mjuːn POS: a	a. 免疫的, 免除的, 不受影响的; n. 免疫者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is immune to a particular infection; a. relating to the condition of immunity; s. secure agains...
bore bɔː POS: n	n. 令人讨厌的人, 激浪, 枪膛, 孔; vt. 使烦扰, 钻孔; vi. 钻孔; bear的过去式; [计] 内径; 孔径 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who evokes boredom; n. diameter of a tube or gun barrel; n. a hole or passage made by a drill; usua...
probable 'prɒbəbl POS: a	a. 很可能的, 大概的, 可信的; n. 很有希望的候选人, 很可能的事情 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an applicant likely to be chosen; a. likely but not certain to be or become true or real; s. apparently dest...
dominance 'domɪnəns POS: n	n. 优势, 显性, 统治, 控制, 支配; [计] 控制, 扰势 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state that exists when one person or group has power over another; n. the organic phenomenon in which o...
thoughtful 'θɔːtful POS: a	a. 深思的, 体贴的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having intellectual depth; a. exhibiting or characterized by careful thought; s. acting with or showing thou...
devotion dɪ'vəʊʃən POS: n	n. 热爱, 投入 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. feelings of ardent love; n. commitment to some purpose; n. (usually plural) religious observance or prayers...
charitable 'tʃærɪtəbl POS: a	a. 大慈大悲的, 宽厚的, 慈善的; [法] 慈善的, 慷慨的, 宽恕的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or characterized by charity; a. full of love and generosity; s. showing or motivated by sympathy...
careless 'keəlis POS: a	a. 粗心的, 不关心的, 无忧无虑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by lack of attention or consideration or forethought or thoroughness; not careful; s. effortless and...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
alcoholic ˌælkəˈhɒlɪk POS: n	n. 酒鬼, 酒精中毒者; a. 酒精的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who drinks alcohol to excess habitually; a. characteristic of or containing alcohol; s. addicted to...
sting stɪŋ POS: n	n. 叮, 刺痛, 刺激, 讽刺; vt. 叮, 刺痛, 刺激, 使苦恼; vi. 叮, 刺痛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a kind of pain; something as sudden and painful as being stung; n. a painful wound caused by the thrust of...
fright fraɪt POS: n	n. 惊骇, 吃惊; [医] 惊吓 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an emotion experienced in anticipation of some specific pain or danger (usually accompanied by a desire to...
conscientious ˌkɒnʃiˈɛnʃəs POS: a	a. 有责任心的, 负责的, 本着良心的; [法] 凭良心做的, 有道德感的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by extreme care and great effort; a. guided by or in accordance with conscience or sense of r...
coward ˈkəʊəd POS: n	n. 懦弱的人, 胆小的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who shows fear or timidity; n. English dramatist and actor and composer noted for his witty and so...
homely ˈhəʊmli POS: a	a. 家事的, 平凡的, 朴实无华的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lacking in physical beauty or proportion; s. plain and unpretentious; s. without artificial refinement or el...